EMPLOYEE DATA PROTECTION POLICY

Policy ID: **POL-001** | Version 2.0 | Effective: 1 January 2025

Document Status: Synthetic policy version for PolicyLens testing

1. Purpose

This policy establishes mandatory safeguards for the collection, use, storage, sharing, retention, and disposal of employee personal data.

2. Scope

This policy applies to employees, contractors, Human Resources, IT, payroll, and third parties processing employee data on the organization's behalf.

3. Data Collection and Transparency

Employee personal data must be collected for specified employment-related purposes and limited to what is necessary. Employees must receive a privacy notice describing the purposes of processing, categories of data, authorized recipients, and applicable retention practices.

4. Access and Confidentiality

Access must follow least-privilege principles and be approved by the relevant data owner. Access permissions must be reviewed at least quarterly. Confidential employee data must not be disclosed without documented authorization.

5. Storage, Security, and Retention

Employee personal data must be stored in approved systems and protected by access controls and encryption where supported. Retention periods must follow the Data Retention Policy (POL-003). Data past its approved retention period must be securely deleted or anonymized unless a documented legal hold applies.

6. Third-Party Sharing

Third parties processing employee data must be approved and bound by written confidentiality and data-protection obligations. Only the minimum necessary data may be shared, and transfers must use approved secure channels.

7. Incident Reporting and Response

Suspected loss, unauthorized access, alteration, or disclosure of employee data must be reported to the designated incident response channel immediately and no later than 24 hours after discovery. The incident must be assessed and handled in accordance with the Data Incident Response Policy (POL-004). Relevant evidence must be preserved.

8. Data Subject Requests

Requests to access or correct employee personal data must be directed to Human Resources or the designated privacy contact and recorded for tracking.

9. Responsibilities and Review

Human Resources is the data owner for employee records. IT maintains technical safeguards. Managers approve role-based access. The compliance function reviews adherence annually, and this policy must be reviewed at least once a year.

Testing note: This synthetic document intentionally includes relationships to Data Retention Policy (POL-003) and Data Incident Response Policy (POL-004) in Version 2.0 so dependency and change-impact analysis can be tested. It is not an official organizational policy or legal advice.